

LESSON 6

The Paael Stem: Intensive, Factitive, and Formal Religious Action

ܐܠܥܠ

PĀ'EL

Worship and religious vocabulary · Conflict with established religion

SECTION 1: REVIEW OF LESSONS 1–5

Cumulative Review

Lesson 6 builds directly on Lesson 5. You should now be comfortable with the Aphel stem (causative). This lesson introduces its close sibling: the Paael, the intensive/factitive stem.

- **Lesson 5 review:** The Aphel stem: 'a- prefix, causative meaning ('to cause X'). Perfect paradigm ('allep), participle (ma'lep). Comparison with Hebrew Hiphil and Arabic Form IV.
- **Lessons 1–4 recap:** Estrangela alphabet; Peal perfect and imperfect; Syriac noun states; Peal participle; basic clause structure.

5-Question Warm-Up Drill

Answer these questions before proceeding. Answers in Section 8.

1. Give the Aphel perfect 3 m.sg. of the root q-r-b (draw near) and translate it.
2. ܐܠܥܠ — what form is this? What is its root and stem?
3. Translate: ܪܘܗܐ ܐܓܠܝ ܫܪܐܪܐ (Rūḥā 'aglī šrārā)

4. What is the Hebrew Hiphil equivalent of the Syriac Aphel? Give one example.
5. Give the Aphel participle (all four forms) of root ' -l-p (teach).

SECTION 2: THE PAAEL STEM

Core Meaning: Intensive and Factitive

The Paael stem (also spelled Pael or Pā' el) expresses two related types of intensified meaning:

- **Intensive:** Repeated, thoroughgoing, or heightened action. 'He wrote' (Peal) → 'he wrote carefully/copied out' (Paael).
- **Factitive:** Causing someone or something to enter into a state. 'Be holy' (Peal) → 'make holy/sanctify' (Paael). The Paael turns intransitive verbs into transitive ones.

Formation: Gemination of the Middle Root Letter

The defining feature of the Paael is the **doubling (gemination) of the middle root consonant (R2)**. This is written with a *dagesh*-like diacritic in pointing, or simply by writing the letter twice in some scripts.

- **Perfect:** CaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern — e.g., barrek (from b-r-k), qaddaš (from q-d-š), yallep (from y-l-p)
- **Participle:** mCaR₁R₂R₂eR₃ pattern (m- prefix) — e.g., mbarrek, mqaddeš, myallep

Cross-Linguistic Comparison

- **Hebrew Piel:** The direct cognate of the Syriac Paael. Also formed by doubling R2. Compare: *kipper* (Piel, 'atone/cover' — from k-p-r), *bērak* (Piel, 'bless' — from b-r-k), *qiddēš* (Piel, 'sanctify'). The structural identity is near-perfect.

- **Arabic Form II:** Formed by doubling R2 (qaddama, 'to present/offer'; 'allama, 'to teach/instruct'; qaddasa, 'to sanctify'). Arabic Form II corresponds precisely to Syriac Paael in both form and function.
- **Greek:** No direct morphological equivalent. Intensives expressed via prefix verbs (e.g., *κατα-* compounds), aspect (perfect), or adverbs. Latin uses intensifying prefixes or separate lexical items.

Paael Examples: Peal → Paael

Peal (Syr)	Root	Peal Meaning	Paael (Syr)	Paael Translit	Paael Meaning
ܒܪܟ	b-r-k	'kneel, bless (Peal)'	ܒܪܟ	barrek	'bless/pronounce blessing'
ܩܕܫ	q-d-š	'be holy (Peal)'	ܩܕܫ	qaddaš	'sanctify/make holy'
ܠܡܕ	y-l-p	'learn (Peal)'	ܠܡܕ	yallep	'teach (make learned)'
ܫܡܫ	š-m-š	'serve (Peal)'	ܫܡܫ	šammeš	'minister/serve formally'
ܕܠܟ	k-n-š	'gather (Peal)'	ܕܠܟ	kanneš	'assemble/collect'

KEY INSIGHT: When the Paael is applied to an INTRANSITIVE verb (e.g., 'be holy'), it makes the action TRANSITIVE and FACTITIVE: 'make X holy / sanctify.' This is called the factitive use, and it is the Paael's most theologically important function. Compare Hebrew Piel kipper ('atone'), qiddēš ('sanctify'), bērak ('bless').

Comparison of the Three Major Stems

Syriac	Peal (basic)	Paael (intensive/factitive)	Aphel (causative)
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy')	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy')	—
b-r-k	berak ('kneel')	barrek ('bless intensively')	—
k-t-b	katab ('write')	katteb ('write carefully/copy')	'aktab ('dictate/cause to write')
y-l-p	yalep ('learn')	yallep ('teach — make learned')	'allep ('cause to learn')
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve')	šammeš ('minister formally')	—

SECTION 3: PAAEL PERFECT PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Paael | Meaning: 'to bless'

ܒܪܟܐ Perfect — Full Conjugation (Root b-r-k)

Person	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	ܒܪܟ	<i>barrek</i>	he blessed
3 f.sg.	ܒܪܟܐ	<i>barrekat</i>	she blessed
2 m.sg.	ܒܪܟܝ	<i>barrekt</i>	you (m.sg.) blessed
2 f.sg.	ܒܪܟܝܐ	<i>barrekti</i>	you (f.sg.) blessed
1 c.sg.	ܒܪܟܝܬ	<i>barrekit</i>	I blessed
3 m.pl.	ܒܪܚܐ	<i>barrekū</i>	they (m.) blessed
3 f.pl.	ܒܪܚܐܝ	<i>barrekī</i>	they (f.) blessed
2 m.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܐ	<i>barrekitūn</i>	you (m.pl.) blessed
2 f.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܝܐ	<i>barrekitin</i>	you (f.pl.) blessed
1 c.pl.	ܒܪܚܝܬܝܢ	<i>barrekin</i>	we blessed

Formation Notes

- **Root: b-r-k.** In the Paael, R2 (resh, r) is geminated: b-rr-k → barrek

- **Perfect vowel pattern:** a under R1, doubled R2, e vowel between R2 and R3 (same as Peal CeCC but with geminate R2)
- **Suffix set:** Essentially identical to Peal and Aphel perfect suffixes
- **Guttural roots:** When R2 is a guttural (Ayin, Het, He, Alaph), gemination may be 'virtual' — compensatory lengthening of the preceding vowel occurs instead

Comparison: Hebrew Piel Perfect

The Hebrew Piel perfect is structurally near-identical to the Syriac Pael perfect. Compare:

Person	Hebrew (Piel)	Transliteration	Translation
3 m.sg.	בִּרְךָ	bērāk	he blessed (Piel b-r-k)
3 f.sg.	בִּרְכָהּ	bērēkāh	she blessed
1 c.sg.	בִּרְכֵּתִי	bēraktī	I blessed
3 m.pl.	בִּרְכוּ	bērēkū	they blessed

SECTION 4: PAEL PARTICIPLE PARADIGM

Root: b-r-k | Stem: Pael | Meaning: 'one who blesses'

The Pael active participle takes the same m- prefix as all derived-stem participles. The gemination of R2 is preserved throughout.

Form	Estrangela	Transliteration	Translation
m.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܐ	<i>mbarrek</i>	blessing (m.sg.)
f.sg.	ܡܒܪܟܬܐ	<i>mbarrkā</i>	blessing (f.sg.)
m.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܝܢ	<i>mbarrkīn</i>	blessing (m.pl.)
f.pl.	ܡܒܪܟܬܝܢ	<i>mbarrkān</i>	blessing (f.pl.)

Formation Notes

- **Prefix:** m- (identical to Aphel participle prefix)

- **Vowel pattern:** m + a + R1R2R2 + e + R3 (preserves gemination of R2)
- **Suffixes:** Standard participle endings: m.sg. (unmarked), f.sg. (-ā), m.pl. (-īn), f.pl. (-ān)

Comparison with Hebrew and Arabic

Hebrew Piel participle: prefix מְ (mě-) + doubled R2. E.g., *měbārēk* (blessing, from b-r-k Piel), *měqaddēš* (sanctifying, from q-d-š Piel). Structurally identical to Syriac Pael participle.

Arabic Form II active participle: pattern muCaCCiC (mu + R1 + a + R2R2 + i + R3). E.g., *mu‘allim* (teacher, from ‘-l-m Form II), *muqaddis* (sanctifier, from q-d-s Form II). The m- prefix and gemination are pan-Semitic features.

SECTION 5: WORSHIP AND RELIGIOUS VOCABULARY

Pael Verbs for Worship and Ministry

Estrangela	Translit	Stem	Meaning	Notes
ܒܪܟܐ	barrek	Paael b-r-k	bless, pronounce blessing	Cf. Heb Piel bērak; Arabic bāraka
ܠܐܬܐ	laṭ	Peal l-ṭ	curse	Antonym of barrek; cf. Heb qillēl
ܫܠܝܬܐ	šallī	Paael š-l-y	pray, intercede	Cf. Heb hitpallēl; Arabic šallā
ܫܓܕܐ	sgad	Peal s-g-d	bow down, worship	Cf. Arabic sajada; Heb hištaḥawāh
ܫܡܡܝܫܐ	šammeš	Paael š-m- š	minister, serve formally	Liturgical service; cf. Hebrew šimmeš
ܝܠܠܥܐ	yallep	Paael y-l-p	teach, instruct	Factitive of 'learn'; cf. Arabic ‘allama
ܩܕܕܝܫܐ	qaddaš	Paael q-d- š	sanctify, make holy	Cf. Heb Piel qiddēš; Arabic qaddasa
ܫܒܚܐ	šabbeḥ	Paael š-b- ḥ	praise, glorify	Cf. Syriac šūbhā (glory); doxological use
ܩܒܠܐ	qabbel	Paael q-b-l	receive, accept (ritual)	Cf. Arabic qabila; used for receiving sacraments
ܡܠܠܐ	mallel	Paael m-l-l	speak, converse, preach	Intensive of speech; cf. Heb millēl
ܕܩܝܐ	dakkī	Paael d-k- y	purify, cleanse	Factitive of 'be pure'; cf. Heb Piel zikkāh
ܡܫܚܐ	mašeḥ	Paael m-š- ḥ	anoint, smear with oil	Root of mēšīḥā (Messiah/Christ); cf. Heb māšaḥ
ܫܡܝܬܐ	šam	Peal š-w- m	fast, abstain	Cf. Heb šûm; Arabic šāma
ܚܓܓܐ	ḥagag	Peal ḥ-g-g	feast, celebrate	Cf. Heb ḥāgag; Arabic ḥajja

Nouns for Temple, Worship, and Religious Community

Estrangela	Translit	Meaning	Notes
ܡܕܒܚܐ	madbhā	altar	From d-b-ḥ (slaughter/sacrifice); cf. Heb mizbēaḥ
ܟܗܢܐ	kāhnā	priest	Cf. Heb kōhēn; Arabic kāhin
ܚܝܟܠܐ	hayklā	temple, sanctuary	Cf. Heb hēḵāl (from Akkadian ēkallu); Gk naos
ܚܝܬܐ	knūštā	synagogue, assembly	From k-n-š (gather); cf. Heb kēneset
ܩܘܪܒܐܢܐ	qūrbānā	offering, sacrifice	From q-r-b (draw near/offer); cf. Heb qorbān (Mark 7:11)
ܒܫܡܐ	besmā	incense, spice	Cf. Heb bōšēn; Arabic balsam
ܡܝܐ	mayyā	water	Pl. form standard; cf. Heb mayim, Arabic mā
ܡܫܗܐ	mešhā	oil, ointment	From m-š-ḥ (anoint); root of Messiah
ܠܚܡܐ	laḥmā	bread, food	Cf. Heb leḥem (Bethlehem = bēt leḥem); Arabic laḥm
ܕܡܐ	kāsā	cup	Cf. Heb kôs; Gk potērion
ܢܡܘܣܐ	nāmūsā	law, Torah	From Gk nomos via Aramaic
ܫܠܬܐ	šlūttā	prayer	Abstract noun from š-l-y (Pael)
ܚܝܬܐ	knūštā	assembly, congregation	Also used for synagogue (same word)
ܩܘܕܢܐ	pūqdānā	commandment, decree	From p-q-d (command); cf. Heb piqqūd
ܢܡܘܣܐ	nāmūsā	law, rule	Dual use: Torah and general law

SECTION 6: THE STORY — PART 6

Yukhannan Blesses the People and Angers the Priests

Narrative note: This passage is rich in Paael forms (barrek, ṣallī, šabbēḥ, yallep, qaddaš, šammeš). It also introduces the central conflict of the Acts: Yuhannan's ministry challenges the established religious order. Notice the theological contrast between sacrifice (qūrbānā) and faith (haymānūttā).

Key Paael forms: barrek (blessed), ṣallī (prayed), šabbēḥ (praised), yallep (taught), qaddaš (sanctified), šammeš (minister), šabbēḥ (praised again at end). Note also metqaddeš — the Ethpaael (passive of Paael), previewing Lesson 7.

Sentence 1

ⲙⲓⲛⲁⲛⲁⲛ ⲙⲉⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ

w-Yukhannan qam ʿ al madbhā w-barrek l- ʿ ammā

*w- (and-) Yuhannan (John) qam (stood) ʿ al (upon) madbhā (the-altar)
w-barrek (and-blessed) l- ʿ ammā (the-people)*

→ *And Yuhannan stood at the altar and blessed the people.*

Sentence 2

ⲙⲓⲛⲁⲛⲁⲛ ⲙⲉⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ ⲛⲓⲛⲁⲛ

w-ṣallī b- ʿ ednā rāmā w-šabbēḥ l-Alāhā

w-ṣallī (and-prayed) b- ʿ ednā (with-voice) rāmā (loud) w-šabbēḥ (and-praised) l-Alāhā (God)

→ *He prayed with a loud voice and praised God.*

Sentence 3

ܠܗܘܢ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

w-yallep lhūn 'ūrḥā ḥattā d-ṣlūttā

w-yallep (and-taught) lhūn (them) 'ūrḥā (the-way) ḥattā (new) d-ṣlūttā (of-prayer)

→ *He taught them the new way of prayer.*

Sentence 4

ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

w- 'emar: lā madbhā d-kahnūttā hū d-qaddaš 'enāš

w- 'emar (and-said) lā (not) madbhā (the-altar) d-kahnūttā (of-the-priesthood) hū (it-is) d-qaddaš (that-sanctifies) 'enāš (a-person)

→ *'It is not the altar of the priesthood that sanctifies a person.'*

Sentence 5

ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

'ellā Māryā hū d-qaddaš lkūn b-rūḥeh

'ellā (but/rather) Māryā (the-Lord) hū (he-is) d-qaddaš (who-sanctifies) lkūn (you(pl.)) b-rūḥeh (by-his-Spirit)

→ *'Rather, it is the Lord who sanctifies you by his Spirit.'*

Sentence 6

ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܡܠܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ ܕܥܠܝܬܐ

šme 'ū dēn kāhnē mellāw-hy w- 'etragzū 'lāw-hy

šme ‘ ū (heard) dēn (but/now) kāhnē (the-priests) mellāw-hy (his-words)
w- ’ etragzū (and-were-angered) ‘ lāw-hy (against-him)

→ *But the priests heard his words and were angered against him.*

Sentence 7

אֲכַלְמָא דְּמַלְכָּא שְׁלֵטָא בְּחַיְלָא
w- ’ emrū: man yahab lāk šulṭānā d-šammeš b-hayklā?

w- ’ emrū: man yahab lāk šulṭānā d-šammeš b-hayklā?

w- ’ emrū (and-they-said) man (who) yahab (gave) lāk (to-you) šulṭānā
(authority) d-šammeš (to-minister) b-hayklā (in-the-temple)

→ *'Who gave you authority to minister in the temple?'*

Sentence 8

בְּרַחֲמֵי אֱלֹהִים שְׂדַרְנִי אֱלֹהִים
‘ nā Yukhannan w- ’ emar: Alāhā šedarnī d- ’ qaddeš l- ’ ammeḥ

‘ nā Yukhannan w- ’ emar: Alāhā šedarnī d- ’ qaddeš l- ’ ammeḥ

‘ nā (answered) Yukhannan (Yukhannan) w- ’ emar (and-said) Alāhā
(God) šedarnī (sent-me) d- ’ qaddeš (to-sanctify) l- ’ ammeḥ (his-people)

→ *Yukhannan answered: 'God sent me to sanctify his people.'*

Sentence 9

לֹא בְּקֻרְבָּנָא עֵלְלָא בְּחַיְמָנֻטָּא מֵתְּקַדְּדֵשׁ עֵנָשׁ
lā b-qūrbānā ’ ellā b-haymānūttā metqaddeš ’ enāš

lā b-qūrbānā ’ ellā b-haymānūttā metqaddeš ’ enāš

lā (not) b-qūrbānā (by-sacrifice) ’ ellā (but) b-haymānūttā (by-faith)
metqaddeš (is-sanctified) ’ enāš (a-person)

→ *'A person is not sanctified by sacrifice but by faith.'*

Sentence 10

וְרֵגַז רַב כַּהֲנֵי וַיִּצְוֶה דְּנִפְּקֻן לֵהּ מִן הַיְּכָלָא

w-regaz rab kāhnē w-pqad d-nuppqūn leh men hayklā

w-regaz (and-was-enraged) rab (chief) kāhnē (of-priests) w-pqad (and-commanded) d-nuppqūn (that-they-expel) leh (him) men (from) hayklā (the-temple)

→ *And the chief priest was enraged and commanded that they expel him from the temple.*

Sentence 11

וְיֻחַנָּן דֵּן לֹא דְּהֵל 'עֵלָא שְׁאֲבֵהּ לֵאלֹהִי בְּכֻלְהּ לֵבְבֵהּ

Yukhannan dēn lā dḥel 'ellā šabbeḥ l-Alāhā b-kulleh lebbeh

Yukhannan (Yukhannan) dēn (but/however) lā (not) dḥel (feared) 'ellā (but) šabbeḥ (praised) l-Alāhā (God) b-kulleh (with-all) lebbeh (his-heart)

→ *But Yukhannan was not afraid; rather he praised God with all his heart.*

SECTION 7: EXERCISES

Exercise 1: Stem Identification (Mixed: Peal, Paael, Aphel)

Identify each verb form: state the stem (Peal/Paael/Aphel), person/number/gender, root, and English meaning.

#	Estrangela	Transliteration
1	ܒܪܝܟ	barrek
2	ܟܬܒ	katab
3	ܐܩܪܒ	'aqreb
4	ܫܒܚ	šabbeḥ
5	ܐܗܝܝ	'aḥyī
6	ܡܒܪܝܟ	mbarrek
7	ܩܕܕܫ	qaddaš
8	ܡܐ ܠܦ	ma 'lep
9	ܫܡܡܝܫ	šammeš
10	ܣܓܕ	sgad
11	ܫܠܝ	šallī
12	ܐܠܠܦ	'allep

Exercise 2: Conjugation Drill

Fully conjugate the following two Paael verbs in the perfect (10 persons) and the participle (4 forms). Use Sections 3–4 as a model.

1. Root *š-b-ḥ* (praise) — Paael: *šabbeḥ*
2. Root *m-l-l* (speak) — Paael: *mallel*

Exercise 3: Translation Drill (Syriac → English)

Translate the following sentences, all containing Paael verbs.

1. ܝܘܚܢܢ ܒܪܝܟ ܠܐܡܡܐ (*Yukhannan barrek l-'ammā*)
2. ܕܡܠܟܐ ܫܡܡܝܫ ܒܗܝܟܠܐ (*Kāhnā šammeš b-hayklā*)
3. ܗܝ ܩܕܕܝܫܬ ܠܒܢܝܝܗ (*Hī qaddešat l-bnāy-hy*)

4. ܡܒܪܝܟ ܐܢܐ ܠܐܠܗܐ (*Mbarrek 'enā l-Alāhā*)
5. ܫܒܒܗܘ ܠܡܪܝܐ ܒܠܟܠ ܝܐܘܡ (*Šabbhū l-Māryā b-kull yawm*)
6. ܐܢܬ ܝܠܠܡܬ ܠܢ ܢܡܘܫܐ (*'Ant yallapt lān nāmūsā*)
7. ܕܟܝܡܝܐ ܠܡܢܬܝܬܐ ܠܡܢܬܝܬܐ (*Dakkī mayyā l-ma' mūdittā*)
8. ܡܢ ܡܫܗ ܒܡܫܗܐ (*Man mšah b-mešhā?*)

Exercise 4: Production Drill (English → Syriac Pael)

Render these sentences into Syriac using the Pael stem.

1. The prophet blessed the offering.
2. They (m.) praised God with a loud voice.
3. The priest sanctified the assembly.
4. She prayed every day in the temple.
5. He anointed the king with oil.
6. We ministered to the Lord together.

Exercise 5: Peal vs. Pael Comparison

For each root pair below, explain how the Peal and Pael meanings differ, and give one example sentence using each.

Root	Peal Meaning	Pael Meaning
q-d-š	qadaš ('be holy' Peal)	qaddaš ('sanctify/make holy' Pael)
b-r-k	berak ('kneel/bless' Peal)	barrek ('bless solemnly' Pael)
y-l-p	yalep ('learn' Peal)	yallep ('teach, make learned' Pael)
š-m-š	šemaš ('serve' Peal)	šammeš ('minister formally' Pael)
d-k-y	dakī ('be pure' Peal)	dakkī ('purify, cleanse' Pael)

Exercise 6: Reading Comprehension

Re-read the story in Section 6, then answer the following questions.

1. What actions does Yukhannan perform at the altar? (List the Pael verbs.)
2. What does Yukhannan teach about the true source of sanctification?
3. How do the priests react, and why?
4. What authority does the chief priest invoke, and what does Yukhannan claim?
5. What does Yukhannan do after being threatened with expulsion?
What does this tell us about his character?

SECTION 8: ANSWER KEY

SECTION 1 WARM-UP

Q1: Aphel perf. 3 m.sg.: אָקֵרַב ('aqreb) = 'he brought near / offered'

Q2:

Q3: 'The Spirit revealed the truth.'

Q4: Hebrew Hiphil — e.g., hiqrīb (brought near, from q-r-b)

Q5: m.sg.: ma 'lep / f.sg.: ma 'lpā / m.pl.: ma 'lpīn / f.pl.: ma 'lpān

Exercise 1: Identification

#	Stem	Person	Root	Meaning
1	Paael	3 m.sg.	b-r-k	he blessed
2	Peal	3 m.sg.	k-t-b	he wrote
3	Aphel	3 m.sg.	q-r-b	he brought near
4	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-b-ḥ	he praised
5	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ḥ-y-y	he gave life
6	Paael ptcp	m.sg.	b-r-k	blessing
7	Paael	3 m.sg.	q-d-š	he sanctified
8	Aphel ptcp	m.sg.	ʾ-l-p	teaching (causative)
9	Paael	3 m.sg.	š-m-š	he ministered
10	Peal	3 m.sg.	s-g-d	he worshipped
11	Paael	3 m.sg.	ṣ-l-y	he prayed
12	Aphel	3 m.sg.	ʾ-l-p	he taught (causative)

Exercise 3: Translation

#	Translation
1	Yukhannan blessed the people.
2	The priest ministered in the temple.
3	She sanctified her children.
4	I am blessing God.
5	They praised the Lord every day.
6	You (m.sg.) taught us the law.
7	He purified the water for baptism.
8	Who anointed with oil?

Exercise 4: Production (sample answers)

1. *Nebīyā barrek l-qūrbānā*

2. *Šabbḥū l-Alāhā b- ʾednā rāmā*

3. *Kāhnā qaddaš l-knūštā*

4. *ṣalleyyat b-kull yawm b-hayklā*

5. *Mšah l-malkā b-mešhā*

6. *Šammešnān l-Māryā ḥdāyīt*

Exercise 6: Comprehension

#	Answer
1	He blessed (barrek), prayed (ṣallī), praised (šabbeḥ), and taught (yallep).
2	Not the altar but the Lord, by his Spirit (b-rūḥeh).
3	They were angered (' etragzū) — he was bypassing priestly authority.
4	Priests claimed temple authority; Yukhannan claimed divine commission (šedarnī).
5	He praised God (šabbeḥ) — showing fearless devotion over fear of human authority.

SECTION 9: GRAMMATICAL SUMMARY

THE PAAEL STEM — FORMATION RULES

Formation feature	Pattern	Example (b-r-k)
Root consonant pattern	R1 + R2 DOUBLED + R3	b-rr-k
Perfect 3 m.sg.	CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	barrek
Participle m.sg.	m + CaR ₁ R ₂ R ₂ eR ₃	mbarrek
Participle suffixes	-ā, -īn, -ān	mbarrkā, mbarrkīn, mbarrkān
Core meaning	Intensive or Factitive	'bless solemnly'; 'sanctify = make holy'

Meaning Pattern

PEAL (basic) + R2 DOUBLED = PAAEL (intensive/factitive) 'to X' → 'to X thoroughly' or 'to make X happen / cause X state' q-d-š: be holy → qaddaš: sanctify | b-r-k: bless → barrek: bless solemnly | y-l-p: learn → yallep: teach

Three-Stem Comparison Table

Stem	Meaning Type	Perfect 3 m.sg.	Participle m.sg.	Translation
Peal	Basic	katab	kāteb	'he wrote' / 'writing'
Paael	Intensive/Factitive	barrek	mbarrek	'he blessed' / 'blessing'
Aphel	Causative	'allep	ma 'lep	'he taught' / 'teaching'

Semitic Language Family Comparison

Syriac	Peal	Paael	Aphel
Meaning	Basic	Intensive/Factitive	Causative
Hebrew (cognate)	Qal	Piel	Hiphil
Arabic (cognate)	Form I	Form II	Form IV
Formation key	Basic vowels	R2 DOUBLED	'a- prefix

FINAL REMINDER: All three stems — Peal, Paael, and Aphel — share the same suffix set for the perfect and the same m- prefix for the active participle. The stems are distinguished by: (1) **Peal:** basic vowels only; (2) **Paael:** R2 gemination; (3) **Aphel:** 'a- prefix.

LOOKING AHEAD — Lesson 7: The Ethpeel and Ethpaael (reflexive/passive stems). You have already seen metqaddeš in this lesson's story — that is the Ethpaael passive of qaddaš. Soon you will master the full passive system of Syriac.

SECTION 11: ADDITIONAL VOCABULARY

The following high-frequency words round out this lesson's vocabulary to 30 terms.

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ቅሪት	qritā	f	village
ረብረብ	leššānā	m	tongue, language
ጭንቀት	garmā	m	bone
ጭንቀት	kēpā	f	stone, rock
ጭንቀት	nūnā	m	fish
ጭንቀት	mdittā	f	city
ረገጥ	šemšā	m	sun
ረገጥ	tar‘ā	m	door, gate
ረገጥ	ḥaylā	m	power, army
ረገጥ	qaysā	m	wood, tree
ረገጥ	nahrā	m	river
ረገጥ	sabrā	m	hope
ረገጥ	deḥltā	f	fear, religion
ረገጥ	sahrā	m	moon
ረገጥ	reglā	f	foot
ረገጥ	šlāmā	m	peace
ረገጥ	’atrā	m	place, country
ረገጥ	sāhdā	m	witness, martyr
ረገጥ	besrā	m	flesh
ረገጥ	ṭaybūtā	f	grace
ረገጥ	tawrā	m	bull, ox
ረገጥ	’ūrḥā	f	way, road
ረገጥ	’aynā	f	eye
ረገጥ	pūmā	m	mouth
ረገጥ	dīnā	m	judgment
ረገጥ	qaddāšā	m	make holy
ረገጥ	qaddšūtā	f	holiness
ረገጥ	palggā	m	divide
ረገጥ	palgūtā	f	division
ረገጥ	saggad	m	worship

ESTRANGELA	TRANSLITERATION	GENDER/TYPE	MEANING
ᲑᲗᲗᲗᲗ	sagdūtā	f	worship
ᲑᲗᲗᲗ	parzappā	m	interpreter
ᲑᲗᲗ	marmā	m	raise, exalt
ᲑᲗᲗᲗ	ṭappā	m	strike, beat